For this application, we'll use the open source SQLite database (which you'll need if you're following along with the code). We're using SQLite version 3 here.

SQLite 3 is the default database for Rails development and was installed along with Rails in Chapter 1, *Installing Rails*. With SQLite 3, no steps are required to create a database, and we have no special user accounts or passwords to deal with. So now you get to experience one of the benefits of going with the flow (or, convention over configuration, as the Rails folks say...ad nauseam).

If it's important to you to use a database server other than SQLite 3, the commands to create the database and grant permissions will be different. You can find some helpful hints in the database configuration section of Configuring Rails Applications in the Ruby on Rails Guides.[37]

Generating the Scaffold

Back in our initial guess at application data , we sketched out the basic content of the `products` table. Now let's turn that into reality. We need to create a database table and a Rails *model* that lets our application use that table, a number of *views* to make up the user interface, and a *controller* to orchestrate the application.

So let's create the model, views, controller, and migration for our `products` table. With Rails, you can do all that with one command by asking Rails to generate a *scaffold* for a given model. Note that on the command line that follows, we use the singular form, `Product`. In Rails, a model is automatically mapped to a database table whose name is the plural form of the model's class. In our case, we ask for a model called `Product`, so Rails associates it with the table called `products`. (And how will it find that table? The `development` entry in `config/database.yml` tells Rails where to look for it. For SQLite 3 users, this'll be a file in the `db` directory.)

Note that the command is too wide to fit comfortably on the page. To enter a command on multiple lines, put a backslash as the last character on all but the last line, and you'll be prompted for more input. Windows users need to